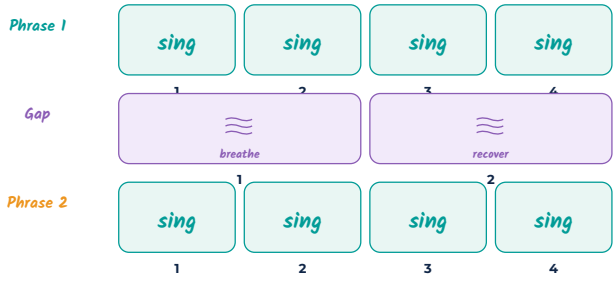
MODULE 02

Breathing & Airflow Control

Plan comfortable breaths that serve the phrase.



Quiet Arrival Breath



Release and Refill

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

11 Quiet Arrival Breath

12 Four-Beat Air Ribbon

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14 Prepare on the Gesture

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17 Airflow Traffic Lights

18 Consonant Air Budget

19 Two-Phrase Breath Map

20 Unhurried Final Release

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 011

Quiet Arrival Breath

Breathing & Airflow Control

3 minutes / No equipment.

Replace a rushed gasp with an unforced inhalation.



A quiet, modest breath

Shoulders stay easy

Speak your greeting

The flower is an image for ease, never a reason to inhale more.

1. Stand or sit comfortably and take two ordinary breaths without changing them.
2. Imagine smelling a mild flower; allow a quiet, modest inhalation, then release it normally.
3. Speak a four-word greeting and repeat after the same easy preparation; rest between attempts.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The greeting begins without an audible gasp or lifted shoulders.

COMMON TRAP

Taking a maximum breath to copy the flower image.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep breaths completely natural if imagery encourages over-inhaling.

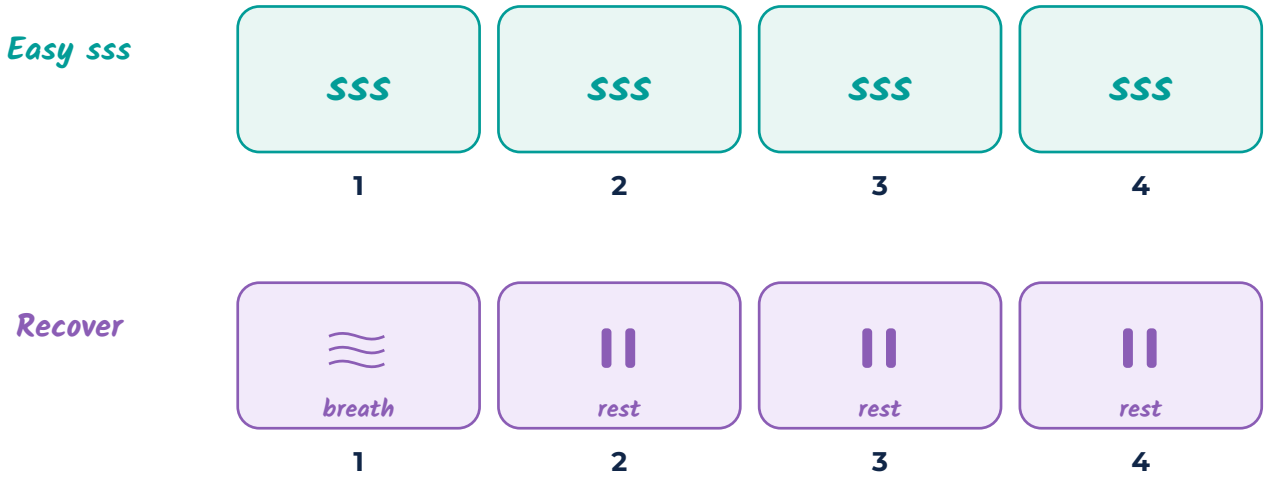
ACTIVITY 012

Four-Beat Air Ribbon

Breathing & Airflow Control

4 minutes / A slow four-beat count.

Release air evenly for a short musical phrase.



One even four-beat release, then normal breathing before another attempt.

1. Inhale comfortably without filling to the maximum; release an easy 'sss' over four steady beats.
2. Rest for at least one normal breath before repeating three times.
3. Sing a gentle four-beat note and compare the steadiness of its ending with the air-only version.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The air stream stays even and the ending does not collapse or squeeze.

COMMON TRAP

Turning the release into a longest-breath contest.

MAKE IT WORK

Use two beats if four is uncomfortable; never compete for the longest breath.

ACTIVITY 013

Breath Mark Detective

Breathing & Airflow Control

5 minutes / One printed or projected phrase.

Choose sensible breath locations in actual repertoire.

Complete thought		Complete thought	
Soft	stars	shine	tonight.
We	sing	as	one.

Original practice text: a breath between complete thoughts, never inside a word.

1. Read the text aloud and underline where its meaning naturally pauses.
2. Mark one shared breath location that respects both the words and the musical phrase.
3. Sing from just before that point twice, checking that the breath does not split a word or rush the next entry.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group can explain why its chosen breath supports the meaning.

COMMON TRAP

Choosing a breath that splits a word.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two-line spoken poem before applying the idea to a score.

ACTIVITY 014

Prepare on the Gesture

Breathing & Airflow Control

4 minutes / Director and a short sung response.

Link an easy preparatory breath to the director's upbeat.



- Watch the preparation
- Breathe without holding
- "loo" on the downbeat

Respond to the gesture; do not guess how long the pause will last.

1. Show a silent preparation gesture and let the group breathe naturally with it; avoid breath holding.
2. Add a comfortable 'loo' on the next downbeat for two beats.
3. Vary the pause before preparation so singers respond to the gesture instead of guessing the timing.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Entrances occur together after the preparation, without a premature gasp.

COMMON TRAP

Holding the breath after the preparation.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a larger gesture and spoken count before removing the count.

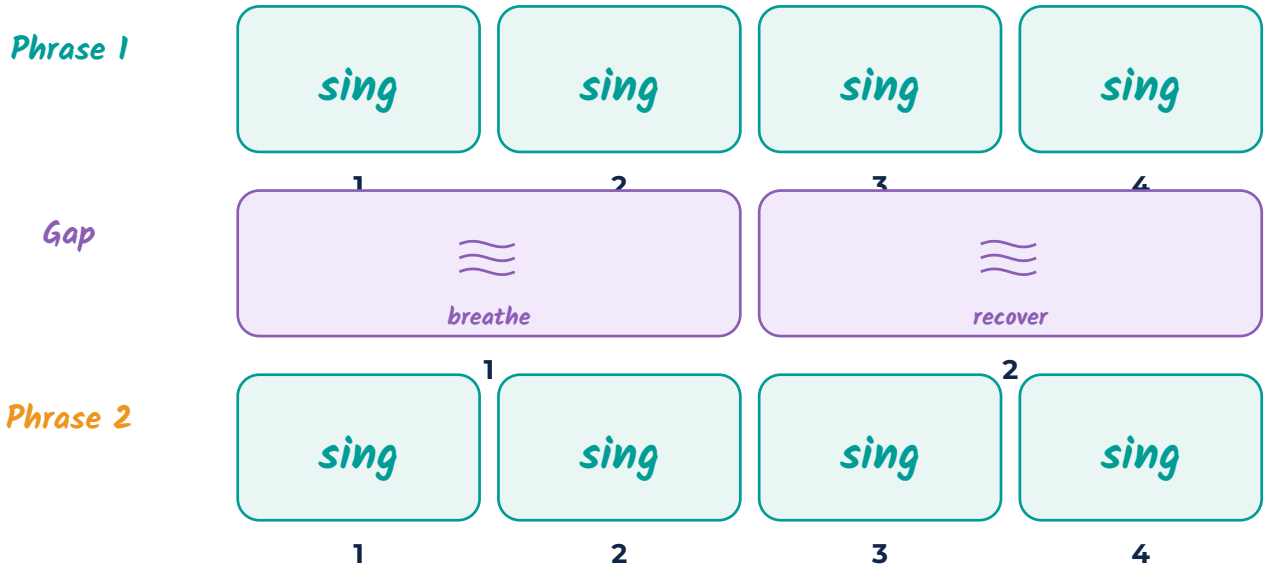
ACTIVITY 015

Release and Refill

Breathing & Airflow Control

4 minutes / Two four-beat phrases.

Recover comfortably between two short phrases.



Keep the two-beat gap available for an unforced recovery breath.

1. *Sing one easy four-beat phrase, then release the last sound cleanly.*
2. *Allow an unforced breath during a clear two-beat gap; keep the throat free rather than holding the air.*
3. *Sing the second phrase and repeat the pair at a pace that leaves enough recovery time.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The second phrase begins as comfortably as the first.

COMMON TRAP

Making the recovery gap too short for the group.

MAKE IT WORK

Extend the gap to four beats; shorten phrases for younger or less experienced groups.

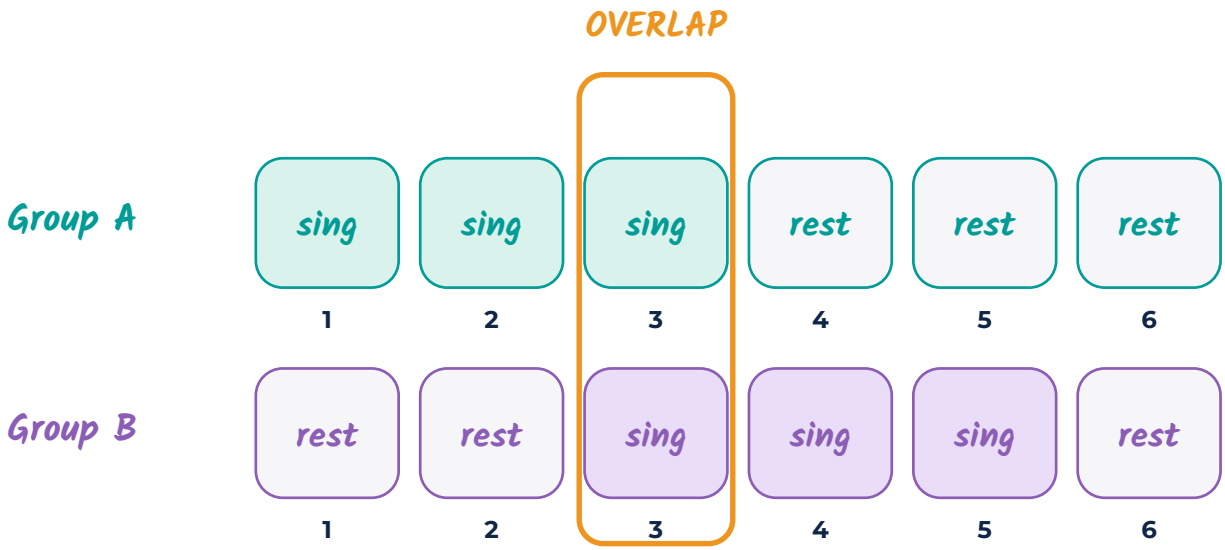
ACTIVITY 016

Staggered Breath Teams

Breathing & Airflow Control

6 minutes / Two groups and a comfortable shared note.

Maintain a sustained ensemble sound without individual breath contests.



Overlap on beat 3. The resting group breathes normally; nobody competes for duration.

1. Group A sings gently for three beats while B rests, then B takes over before A stops.
2. Repeat with a one-beat overlap, letting each singer take ordinary breaths in their rest time.
3. Move into a held chord from the repertoire and plan individual breaths away from the final release.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The ensemble sound continues while individuals breathe without pressure.

COMMON TRAP

Asking one group to sustain beyond comfort.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep two clear teams until the continuous sound is stable.

ACTIVITY 017

Airflow Traffic Lights

Breathing & Airflow Control

4 minutes / Green and red cards, or two hand signs.

Connect preparation, sound, and release without holding the breath.



Easy four-beat sound

Release, then normal breathing

Red means recovery, not holding the air in silence.

1. Explain green as an easy four-beat sound and red as a release followed by normal breathing.
2. Alternate green and red while singers use a gentle 'vvv' or a voiced 'oo'.
3. After three cycles, transfer the same coordination to the first note of a song.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Red produces a clean release, not a tense suspended breath.

COMMON TRAP

Treating red as a tense breath hold.

MAKE IT WORK

Use only an ordinary spoken vowel if voiced fricatives feel awkward.

ACTIVITY 018

Consonant Air Budget

Breathing & Airflow Control

5 minutes / Phrase 'Soft stars shine tonight'.

Notice how repeated consonants affect a phrase.

Soft | stars | shine | tonight

Concise s / sh | Keep clear vowels | Finish the final word

Speak first, then use one note. Do not stretch the consonants.

1. Speak the phrase slowly and notice air escaping on 's' and 'sh'; do not exaggerate them.
2. Speak again with concise consonants and clear vowels on four beats.
3. Sing the words on one note, then on their melody, keeping room to finish the final word.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The final word remains clear without pushing to the end.

COMMON TRAP

Stretching every s and sh to sound clearer.

MAKE IT WORK

Choose a shorter phrase with fewer consonants if needed.

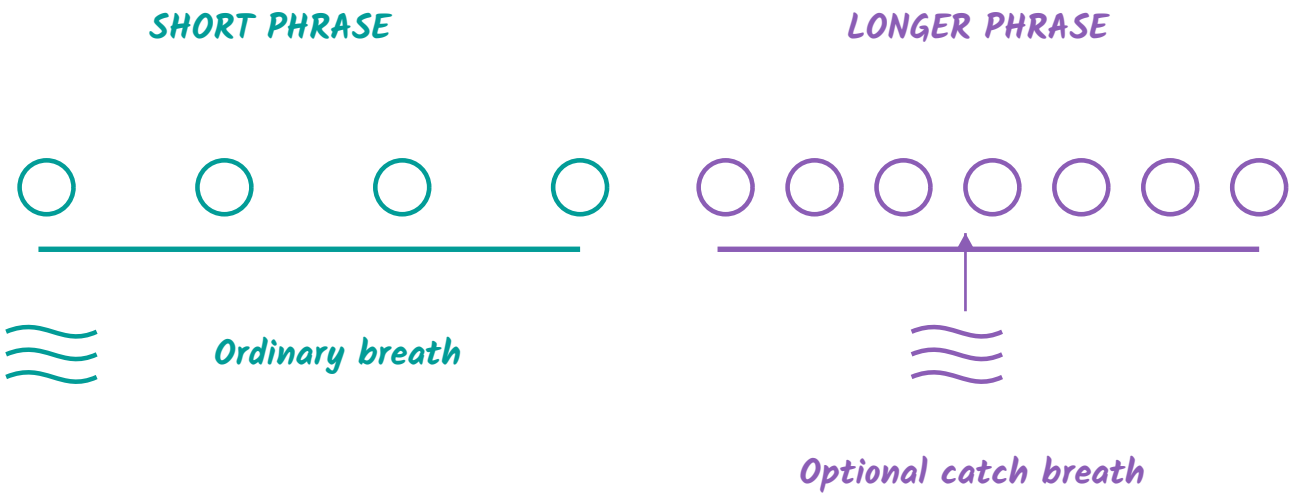
ACTIVITY 019

Two-Phrase Breath Map

Breathing & Airflow Control

6 minutes / Two contrasting phrases from a score.

Plan different breaths for short and longer musical ideas.



Choose a shorter unit when needed

Plan for the phrase you can sing comfortably; split a longer line when needed.

1. Speak both phrases and decide where each one should lead.
2. Rehearse the shorter phrase with an ordinary breath; rehearse the longer one at a manageable tempo with an optional marked catch breath.
3. Sing them in order and check whether the plan fits the group's current ability.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir uses a repeatable plan rather than running out of air unpredictably.

COMMON TRAP

Asking for more air instead of shortening the phrase.

MAKE IT WORK

Split the longer phrase instead of asking singers to inhale more forcefully.

ACTIVITY 020

Unhurried Final Release

Breathing & Airflow Control

4 minutes / One held note from repertoire.

Finish a note together while allowing an easy recovery.

Sustain

oo	oo	oo	release
1	2	3	4

Afterwards

normal	breathing
1	2

Watch the closing gesture on beat 4; let breathing return immediately.

1. Sing a comfortable note for three beats and watch a visible closing gesture on beat four.
2. Release the vowel and allow normal breathing immediately afterwards.
3. Repeat with a final consonant placed exactly at the release; compare the endings.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers stop together without squeezing the last moment or holding their breath afterwards.

COMMON TRAP

Squeezing the final moment before recovery.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two-beat hold and no consonant first.